AI enabled SDLC:

We have come far, we have a long way to go

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- From **Buzzword** driven development to **impact** driven development. 📈
- Retro Games 🕹️👾
- Building **Lego** sets

Vibe Coding

Usual workflow

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- Write a prompt
- Receive generic code that does not make sense
- You correct it with more context
- Better but still misaligned
- You Give up (the AI does not..)

What your AI agent looks like

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- Infinitely fast
- Technically excellent - in general
- Knows nothing specific about your project
- No memory of yesterday's session
- Patterns from other codebases that don't fit yours


Nishant | Citrea @nishant_zk · 20h
Ek Developer Vibe Coder ban sakta hai !
But
Ek Vibe Coder kabhi developer nahi ban sakta !
105
300
3.7K
85K


Post
Uncle Bob Martin
@unclebobmartin
Vibe coding is not the same as disciplined agentic development.
9:16 PM · Mar 10, 2026 · 55K Views

AI Enabled SDLC

Habit changes

- Brief your AI before you start
- Design before you code
- Write your team’s rules
- Keep a decision log (Memory)
- Capture what you learn

Brief your AI before your start

- What and What NOT
- Define stack, framework
- Non-negotiables
- Project Structure
- Code Patterns
- Naming Conventions
- <Add custom instruction>

Gotchas

- Outdated CLAUDE.md files can mislead.
- Brevity wins.
- Institutional memory lives in the repo.
- AI-generated first drafts need human review.

Design before you code

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- Scope : What does this actually do? What's explicitly out of scope for now?
- Components: What are the components?
- Data flow : How do they connect? What happens on the error paths?
- Interfaces: What do the function signatures and types look like?
- Execution: Execute the discussion post approval

Gotchas

- Explicitly gate each step. Explicitly say "wait for approval at each step".
- Push back during design. Review carefully.
- Write approved decisions into the implementation-guide.
- Be careful about what is in the scope and out of scope.

Write your team’s rules

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- **Scenario**: Imagine, two developers using the same AI tool
- **Problem**: Different output quality. The senior engineers thinking is in the head
- **Fix** is to write instructions.
  - Generation instructions: How to build new code , patterns, naming, error handling
  - Refactoring instructions: How to improve existing code without breaking contracts
  - Security checklist: Your specific threat model
  - Review checklist: Your quality gate, what gets blocked, what gets flagged

Gotchas

- Skills that try to cover everything enforce nothing.
- Skill files go stale too. Keep it updated.
- The first version coule be wrong. Review them.

Keep a decision log (Memory)

- **Problem**: AI memory is ephemeral
- **Problem**: Waste time re-explaining context at the start of session
- **Fix** is to create living decision document - a working record
  - Decision record not just for project but also features as well
  - Implementation Guide - Intention: What to build and why
  - Execution Report - Result: What was built, what changed, how to run it

Gotchas

- Document rejected alternatives, not just the happy path.
- Be careful about what to document per story. Can end up with multiple files.
- Write the execution report immediately after implementation.

Capture what you learn

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- **Problem 1**: Repeated mistakes collaborating with AI
- **Problem 2**: No knowledge base from mistakes
- **Fix** is to create living decision document - a working record
- After each story. Three questions:
  - What did AI consistently get wrong?
    - Add a guardrail to `CLAUDE.md` or a skill file
  - What prompt worked really well?
    - Save it as a template in `context/04-prompt-templates.md`
  - What was missing from the briefing that I had to explain mid-session?
    - Add it to `context/01-base-instructions.md`

Gotchas

- **Assign retro ownership explicitly.**
- **Guardrails belong in a PR, not a chat message.**
- **When a session goes well, make a note of what prompt worked.**

Onboarding to existing code

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- Treat AI agent like an engineer who joins your team
- Produce
  - base_instructions.md - Stack, Rules, Non-negotiables
  - file_patterns.md - Package Layout, Naming conventions, Code Patterns

Questions?

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